

exist. So unless you deal with the root problems, the symptoms will always return. Since the problems are spiritual in nature, only God can cure them.

“No couple can keep their assets separated and be one. Naomi, I can’t tell you what to do. All I can do is offer you counsel based on what I believe God would have both you and Ben do. I want you each to take some time to think and pray about your decisions. Call me when you have made a decision, and we’ll get back together.

“In the meantime, Ben, I want you to call the bankruptcy court’s trustee, George Helms. Give him the facts, and let him know that we’re working together. George and I have communicated many times, so if he has a question, tell him to call me. Also, I want you to contact the manager of the bank that holds the note on your car and tell him that we’re working out a plan and will be in contact with him in the next two weeks. But you’ll have to pay at least the minimum on the Visa bill, or your Chapter 13 plan will be in jeopardy.”

During the next few days Naomi hardly spoke to Ben. He tried to be as helpful as possible by doing things around the house and taking Timmy on walks in the evenings.

Naomi found herself in a state of confusion during the week. She had separated herself from Ben financially, if not physically. She considered what Bryan Stanford had said about their problems being as much spiritually based as financially based. Inside she knew he was right. She had been drifting away from the Lord. It was as if her faith had crumbled at the first real test she had ever faced.

Finally, she made the decision to cross the invisible line back into her marriage. She vowed to God that she would commit her resources to her marriage and work at becoming one with Ben. She realized that this might not be the best time in life to finish college, and that she might have to put off her dream of going into marketing, at least for the time being.

Suddenly, having made the decision, she felt free, as if a great burden had been lifted from her shoulders. She could hardly wait to